Ardmore Parish Newsletter

Sunday, 10th May 2026

Sixth Sunday of Easter

Thoughts on the Gospel

The Gospel today is spoken on the night before Jesus' death. The disciples are anxious, and Jesus responds not with strategies but with presence. He promises that God will be closer to them after His departure than before it. The Spirit becomes the inner teacher who helps us recognise Christ alive in our daily lives.

When we feel abandoned, overwhelmed, or spiritually flat, this passage insists that God is already within us — quietly working, strengthening, and guiding. When we allow the Spirit to dwell in us, our actions begin to reflect the One who loves us first.

This Gospel passage is Jesus' promise that love, obedience, and the presence of the Holy Spirit are inseparable. Obedience here is not fear-based; it is love-shaped.

The heart of the passage is this:
You are never left alone. God's own life moves toward you, dwells within you, and empowers you to love.

🙏 Prayer to Our Lady of Fatima

(Feast Day – 13th May)

O Radiant Mother, clothed in heaven's light,
you came to humble fields, where children's eyes
beheld your face more gentle than the dawn,
and heard your call to turn our hearts to God.

Teach us the silence that can hear His voice,
the courage to repent, the will to pray;
wrap us within your mantle's tender shade,
and guard our steps along the narrow way.

Queen of the Rosary, star in the world's dark,
intercede for peace where hatred burns;
let mercy bloom where sorrow's roots run deep,
till every soul to Christ's embrace returns.

🌹 The Little Way Novena – St Eugene's Cathedral

9th – 17th May
Theme: *"My peace consists in remaining little."*

- **Saturday 9th May:** Opening Mass at 7.30 pm with the Sacrament of the Sick
- **Sunday 10th May:** Devotions & Talk at 6 pm
- **Monday – Friday (11th – 15th May):**
  - Novena Masses at 6.30 am & 10 am
  - Evening Service with Guest Speaker at 7.30 pm
- **Saturday 16th May:** 10 am Mass for those who have died
- **Sunday 17th May:** Closing Ceremony at 3 pm with Blessing of Roses

Everyone is warmly welcome for this special time of prayer and petition.
Follow online via:
St Eugene's Cathedral Webcam

🕊️ Knock Pilgrimage to Pray for Peace in the Holy Land

Saturday 16th May – Knock Shrine

Organised by Aid to the Church in Need and led by Bishop William Shomali.

- Message of Hope at 11 am
- Mass at 3 pm

All are welcome. More information available at:
Aid to the Church in Need Ireland

🚌 Derry Diocesan Pilgrimage to Knock Shrine

Saturday 6th June

In conjunction with the All Ireland Rosary Rally.

- Bus departs St Eugene's Cathedral at 8 am
- Cost: **£50** *(includes dinner in Knock House Hotel after Mass in the Basilica)*

☎️ Contact Karen: 028 71262894
📧 cathedral@derrydiocese.org

⛰️ Diocese of Derry Pilgrimage to Lough Derg

24th – 26th July 2026

A three-day pilgrimage of prayer, reflection, and renewal.

- Bus travelling via Strabane and Lifford
- Cost: **£95 / €110** *(includes transport)*

Booking forms and details available at:
Derry Diocese – Lough Derg Information

🌍 Diocesan Youth Pilgrimage to Fatima

3rd – 8th August

Open to young people aged 16+.

A unique faith experience with young pilgrims from around the world.

- Cost: **£820**

☎️ 028 71264087
📧 bethany.doherty@derrydiocese.org

🛫 Pilgrimage to Lourdes

3rd – 8th July 2026

Flights from Derry.
Full Board: £899

☎️ Maria: 028 81648357
📱 WhatsApp: 07768 395038

🎶 St Eugene's Cathedral Scholars 2026/27

Open to full-time students aged 16+.

Choral scholars sing weekly with the Cathedral Choir and at special liturgies and events. Instruction in choral music is provided, together with a stipend.

📧 maghnusmonaghan@hotmail.com
Closing Date: 11th May 2026

🌸 **Medjugorje Pilgrimages 2026**

(45th Anniversary Pilgrimage)

24th June – 1st July

- Depart Dublin → Mostar
- Return Split → Dublin
- Cost: **€855 pps**
- Single Supplement: **€170**

☎ Ursula O Faodhagain, Castlefin: 087 2960562

🙏 **Lough Derg Retreats & Pilgrimages**

Day Retreats – Guided Prayer & Reflection

Dates:
May 12, 17, 23, 25
August 18, 22, 23, 29, 31
September 5, 6, 9, 12, 15, 19, 20

- Admission: **€50**
- Booking essential

3-Day Pilgrimages

29th May – 15th August

- Admission: **€85**
- Booking advised

☎ +353 (0)71 9861518
📧 info@loughderg.org

✨ **Monthly Mass in Honour of Sr Clare Crockett**

Mass will be celebrated **today (Sunday)** at **7 pm** in the **Carmelite Retreat Centre, Termonbacca, Derry**.

All are welcome.

🎓 Catholic School Leadership Development Opportunities

The Derry Diocesan Catechetical Centre, in partnership with St Mary's University, offers:

- Masters in Catholic School Leadership
- Postgraduate Diploma
- Postgraduate Certificate

Ideal for those in leadership or aspiring leadership roles within Catholic education.

📧 tferry@derrydiocese.org
☎ 0044 28 71264087

Online Information Session: **8th June at 4 pm**

💙 Ladies' Weekend Retreat

"In the Upper Room with Mary"

22nd – 24th May
Termonbacca, Derry

Led by the Sisters of the Apostles of the Sacred Heart of Jesus.

- Cost including accommodation: **£90**

☎ Aoife: 028 71262512
📧 termonbaccaderry@ocd.ie

💍 Marriage Preparation Course

Places remain available for the **19th/20th June** course at the **Everglades Hotel, Derry**.

Please note: no courses are being facilitated during July or August.

Book online at:
Accord NI

🔥 **Encounter Weekend – Donegal**

Radisson Blu, Letterkenny

Friday 5th June – Saturday 6th June

Experience:

- Spirit-led worship
- Inspiring talks
- Healing service
- Sacraments & fellowship

Bookings available at:
Encounter Weekend Donegal Booking

📧 donegal@encounterschool.org

🤍 **Silent Retreat – Foyer of Charity**

Carmelite Retreat Centre, Termonbacca

13th – 19th July

Preached by Fr Kilian Byrne

Theme: *"If you but knew the gift of God…"*

- Cost: **£395 / €450 full board**

☎️ Helen: 00353 86 1678027
📧 hellywilliams@gmail.com

Visit:
Foyer of Charity Ireland

A privileged time away from noise and distraction to listen to the Spirit of God through silence, prayer, teaching, and liturgy.

🎜 **Strabane Chorale Concert**

St Mary's Church, Melmount

Sunday 31st May at 5 pm

Featuring guest German choir **Chor Levantate**.

A musical evening to suit all tastes.
Retiring collection in aid of choir and church funds.

Everyone welcome.

🚌 **Murlog Parish Pilgrimage to Knock Shrine**

Saturday 25th July

- Departing Murlog Chapel at 7.15 am
- Cost: **€50** *(includes coach, refreshments & meal)*

☎ James: 085 8767999
☎ Mary: 087 7625237
☎ Bernie: 078 53272541